

PACK THIS

- ☐ **Bear spray** — on a hip or chest strap, not buried in the pack
- ☐ **2–3 L water** each, plus a filter or tablets
- ☐ **Lunch and more snacks** than you think you need
- ☐ **A gallon zip** as the group trash bag
- ☐ **Trowel, TP, and a second zip** to carry it back out
- ☐ **Hand sanitizer**
- ☐ **Rain shell and a warm layer** — Logan Pass is cold and windy even in August
- ☐ **Sun** — hat, sunscreen, sunglasses
- ☐ **Offline map** downloaded before you lose service
- ☐ **Headlamp** on the long days
- ☐ **First aid and blister tape**

THE MORNING OF

- ☐ **Check the trailhead board** for bear activity and closures
- ☐ **Confirm today's times** — shuttle on Day 2, boat on Day 3
- ☐ **Agree on a turnaround time** before anyone starts walking
- ☐ **Tell someone the plan** — which trail, and when you expect to be back at the car
- ☐ **Fill every bottle** and check the weather at the pass, not in town

Bear spray can't fly. Buy it once you land — park stores and the gateway towns sell it, and some outfitters rent it. Check the expiry date, keep it somewhere you can reach in two seconds, and know which way the safety clip comes off *before* you need it.

! Bears: don't surprise one

Almost every bad encounter starts with a bear that had no idea you were coming. Your job is to never be a surprise.

- **Make noise — constantly.** Talk, and keep talking. Call out at blind corners, in thick brush, near berry patches, and anywhere running water is covering the sound of you.
- **Your voice beats any gadget.** Bear bells are too quiet and sound nothing like a person. Use words, out loud, every minute or so.
- **Hike as a group of three or more, and stay together.** Larger groups are charged far less often. Nobody races ahead, nobody trails behind, nobody puts in headphones.
- **Dawn, dusk and poor visibility** are the riskiest hours — be louder then.
- **Read the trailhead board.** Trails close for bear activity, and a closure is not a suggestion.
- Stay **100 yards** from any bear. That is the rule in the park, and no photo is worth closing the gap.

2 If you actually see one

- **Stop. Do not run.** Running triggers a chase, and a grizzly is faster than you over any distance.
- **Group up** and stand tall together. Pick up small children.
- **Talk to it** in a low, level voice so it reads you as human.
- **Back away slowly**, sideways, watching it. Leave it an exit — never corner a bear or come between a sow and cubs.
- **Keep your pack on.** It is body armour, and dropping it teaches a bear that people mean food.

IF IT CHARGES

- Most charges are bluffs. **Stand your ground** and get the spray out of its holster.
- **Spray at roughly 30–60 feet:** aim slightly down and lay a cloud between you and the bear. Keep spraying as it comes through.
- **Grizzly that makes contact — play dead.** Face down, legs spread, hands laced behind your neck, pack on. Stay down until you are certain it is gone.
- **Black bear, or any bear stalking you — fight back.** Hard, at the face, with anything you have.

F Food & water

- **Calorie-dense, no cooking:** nuts, jerky, hard cheese, tortillas with nut butter, dried fruit, bars.
- **Salt matters as much as sugar** on a six-to-eight hour day. Bring electrolytes, not just water.
- **2–3 L each.** Refill only through a filter or tablets — giardia is in these streams however clean the water looks.
- **Eat where you can see around you** — in the open, not in thick brush.
- **Food stays in the pack; the pack stays with you.** Not left on a rock for a photo, not at the shore for a swim.

T Trash: all of it comes out

- **Food waste is trash too** — apple cores, orange peel, pistachio shells, crusts, crumbs from the bottom of the bag.
- **"It's natural, it'll rot" doesn't hold here.** It breaks down slowly, and it teaches animals that the trail means food — which is how a bear ends up destroyed.
- One person carries **the group trash zip**.
- **Micro-trash counts:** wrapper tear-offs, tape, twist ties, fruit stickers.
- Nothing goes down a pit toilet except what a body makes.

B Bathroom, done properly

- **Go at the trailhead.** Avalanche, Logan Pass and Many Glacier all have toilets.
- **Otherwise: 200 feet** — about 70 adult paces — from water, trail and camp.
- **Dig a cathole 6–8 inches deep** in dark soil, then fill it in and scatter leaf litter over it.
- **Toilet paper and hygiene products pack out**, in a doubled opaque zip — TP doesn't break down quickly, and used products carry scent.
- **Pee on rock or gravel** — animals dig up salty soil and wreck the plants around it.
- **Take your bear spray with you and tell someone where you went.** Stepping off the trail alone and quiet is precisely the situation the noise rule exists for.